PLAKSHA UNIVERSITY

CONFAI

CONFERENCE ON

artificial intelligence

2026

OCT 30 - NOV 1

Plaksha University Campus,
Mohali, Punjab

Organized by

Harish and Bina Shah School of AI & Computer Science,
Plaksha University

Overview

ConfAI 2026, hosted by the Harish and Bina Shah School of AI & Computer Science, is a three-day academic conference that highlights the potential of AI to address pressing societal challenges. Through talks and discussions, it brings together students, researchers and practitioners from across AI domains to share knowledge, collaborate and shape the future of research, development and real-world applications in the AI landscape.

6+
Keynote Speakers

25+
Oral Presenters

75+
Poster Presenters

500+
Attendees

Conference Highlights

- **Engage with Prominent Keynote and Guest Speakers:** Top leaders from industry and academia will share their research across eight curated tracks.
- **Explore Latest AI Research:** Attend cutting-edge research presentations highlighting the newest breakthroughs in AI.
- **Gain Practical Frameworks and Insights:** Explore critical questions around AI, innovation, emerging technologies and their broader societal impact.
- **Be a Part of Collaborative Networking:** Build visibility for research collaborations and engage in industry conversations.

Featured Keynote Speakers*



Dr Balaraman Ravindran
Head, Department of Data Science & AI, **IIT Madras**
PhD - University of Massachusetts Amherst



Dr Manish Gupta
Senior Director, **Google DeepMind**
PhD - University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign



Dr Parag Singla
Professor, Department of Computer Science and Engineering, **IIT Delhi**
PhD - University of Washington



Dr Ponnurangam Kumaraguru
Visiting Scientist, **ANRF**
Professor, **IIIT Hyderabad**
PhD - Carnegie Mellon University



Dr Sanghamitra Bandyopadhyay
Former Director, **ISI Kolkata**
Padma Shri awardee
PhD - Indian Statistical Institute



Dr Santanu Chaudhury
Dean, Vachani School of Advanced Computing; Professor, **Ashoka University**
PhD - IIT Kharagpur

**Non-exhaustive list. Additional speakers to be announced.*

Track 1

AI in the Economy

This track examines AI as a force reshaping three interlocking pillars of modern economies: labor markets, financial systems and governance structures.

In labor markets, topics of interest include automation and job displacement, AI-augmented productivity, monitoring and evaluation, reskilling and workforce transitions and the distributional effects of AI adoption.

In finance, the track covers algorithmic trading and market microstructure, AI-driven credit scoring and lending, fraud detection, robo-advisory systems and the use of large language models in financial forecasting and regulatory compliance.

In governance, the scope runs from AI in public administration and policy design to algorithmic accountability and auditing, AI regulation frameworks and the role of AI in macroeconomic policymaking and central banking; it extends to public systems, including smart city infrastructure, AI-driven traffic and mobility optimization, land-use modeling and the equitable allocation of public resources across communities.

TRACK CO-CHAIRS



Alok Ranjan
Assistant Professor,
Plaksha University



Nikhil George
Visiting Assistant Professor,
Plaksha University



Divyanshu Jain
Assistant Professor,
Plaksha University

Track 2

AI in Healthcare

AI systems can be designed and deployed to deliver personalized healthcare while ensuring fair and inclusive access. This track examines both goals: personalizing healthcare and widening access to it.

Topics of interest include precision medicine, early disease detection and adaptive care pathways. In access and delivery, presentations cover low-cost diagnostics, telemedicine and language-inclusive tools that extend healthcare reach. The track equally welcomes work on the limitations and risks within each of these areas, including algorithmic bias, data underrepresentation, the digital divide, and the risk of widening existing health disparities.

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Sunita Chauhan
Dean of Research; Professor,
Plaksha University



Monika Sharma
Program Chair,
Biological Systems Engineering
Associate Professor,
Plaksha University



Sandeep Manjanna
Assistant Professor,
Plaksha University



Chaitanya Lekshmi Indira
Director, Center for Equitable and Personalized Healthcare
Associate Professor,
Plaksha University



Track 3

AI in Sensing

Track 3 focuses on intelligent application domains, hardware-software co-designing of sensors and deployment physics. Contributions are from researchers working on sensors, data acquisition boards and intelligent transducer networks that support prediction and real-time decision systems. Previously published work is eligible for submission.

Topics include accessibility, clean water, cognitive load assessment, critical infrastructure, Edge AI hardware systems, education, entertainment, environment, food security, gaming, green energy, haptics, Industry 5.0, life on poles, PolSAR imaging, quantum materials for circular electronics, quantum sensors, rehabilitation, sanitation, satellite technology, security and surveillance, smart agriculture, sports, underwater world and wearables.

TRACK CO-CHAIRS



Anil K. Roy
Professor,
Plaksha University



Praveen Kumar
Associate Professor,
Plaksha University



Track 4

Reasoning in Vision Language Models

As AI models get better at processing visual and textual information, it becomes increasingly important to understand whether they can actually reason through complex problems. Benchmark scores measure performance, but they do not necessarily explain the reasoning behind it. Therefore, researchers need more comprehensive ways to evaluate reasoning capabilities.

The track spans benchmarking for reasoning; fine-tuning and inference time scaling; probing and analysis techniques; and training methods and architectures built for reasoning. It brings researchers and practitioners together to present recent advances; it also invites discussion and collaboration on strengthening both the benchmarks and the reasoning capabilities of vision-language models.



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Pankaj Pansari
Assistant Professor,
Plaksha University

Deepan Muthirayan
Assistant Professor,
Plaksha University



Track 5

AI4Cities: Resilience & Liveability

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Anupam Sobti
Assistant Professor,
Plaksha University



Malini Balakrishnan
Director,
Center for Water Security
Professor,
Plaksha University



Prashanth Suresh Kumar
Assistant Professor,
Plaksha University



Pankaj Pansari
Assistant Professor,
Plaksha University

Tier-2 and Tier-3 Indian cities are expanding quickly while facing extreme weather driven by climate change. The result is strain on urban infrastructure: erratic power and water supply, inadequate solid waste and wastewater management, urban flooding and traffic congestion. Traditional planning approaches cannot keep pace with such rapid development.

AI offers a route to predictive urban management through real-time, data-driven insight. It supports anticipating water and energy demand, optimizing waste and wastewater systems and raising the overall quality of living.

Track 5 includes work from predictive urban management and infrastructure systems to the governance, data-sharing and institutional questions that decide whether such tools reach the cities that need them.

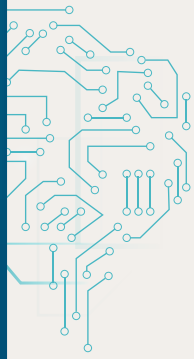


Track 6

Responsible and Ethical AI

AI is reshaping institutions, economies and social relations faster than governance structures can adapt. Foundational ethical theory informs practical governance models, including structures for accountability, transparency and stakeholder participation. Algorithmic fairness, epistemic risks, power concentration, and the design of cross-jurisdictional regulatory frameworks are central concerns, particularly for generative and agentic AI systems.

Track 6 examines the ethical, legal and sociotechnical dimensions of responsible AI, drawing on computer science, law, philosophy, political science and sociology. Contributions that treat responsible AI as a human and social problem, not simply a technical one, are included.



TRACK CO-CHAIRS



Rajesh Sharma
Associate Dean, Harish and Bina Shah School of AI & Computer Science
Program Chair, Computer Science & Artificial Intelligence
Professor,
Plaksha University

Dr Shachindra Nath
Co-founder & Chief Innovation Officer,
Anādi Intelligence



Track 7

AI and Logic: Relations and Applications

Logic and AI shape each other. Logic gives AI its foundations, from theorem proving and model checking to event calculus, ontology-based reasoning on the web, and epistemic reasoning in multi-agent systems. It also supplies the rigorous guarantees needed to protect data privacy and sensitive information. AI, in turn, can be trained to solve logical problems, including mathematical ones.

Track 7 comprises submissions across the full span of work connecting AI and logic.



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Deepak Khemani
Professor,
Plaksha University



Saeed Salehi
Professor,
Plaksha University



Tapas Pandit
Assistant Professor,
Plaksha University

Track 8

Recent Advances in AI

Presentations are not limited to the seven tracks. Any work within the scope of the conference is welcome, whether ongoing research or previously published.



TRACK CO-CHAIRS



Ankur Nahar
Assistant Professor,
Plaksha University

Srijita Chakraburty
Visiting Assistant Professor,
Plaksha University





Sushant Vijayan
Visiting Assistant Professor,
Plaksha University

Event Sponsors

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A global technology company operating in more than 180 markets, Lenovo's portfolio spans intelligent devices, data center infrastructure and technology services, from ThinkPad and Legion PCs to servers, edge computing and cloud solutions. The company's key focus is Hybrid AI, which brings together AI-enabled devices, AI-ready infrastructure and AI-powered services to help organizations adopt AI at scale.

Fore Solutions Pvt Ltd
An NVIDIA Elite Partner and Certified DGX Authorized Reseller, the company has more than 100 AI infrastructure deployments across India. Its portfolio spans AI labs and Centers of Excellence, AI factories, DGX lifecycle management and NVIDIA software integration. Its work includes projects at Thapar Institute of Engineering & Technology, Patiala and Dayananda Sagar University, Bengaluru.

Vehant Technologies
Incubated at IIT Delhi in 2005, Vehant Technologies is a leading provider of AI-powered security, surveillance and safety solutions. Its portfolio spans video analytics, X-ray imaging and RF technologies, including baggage and cargo scanners, under-vehicle scanning systems and intelligent traffic enforcement. Vehant's solutions serve aviation, critical infrastructure, smart cities, highways, and logistics and ports.

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- **Anil K. Roy** - Professor, Plaksha University; PhD – IIT Delhi
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- **Dr Arun Kumar** - Associate Professor, IIT Ropar; PhD – IIT Bombay
- **Dr Shachindra Nath** - Co-founder & Chief Innovation Officer, Anādi Intelligence; PhD – Central Saint Martins, University of the Arts London
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- **Malini Balakrishnan** - Director, Center for Water Security; Professor, Plaksha University; PhD – IIT Delhi
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- **Swagata Halder** - Assistant Professor, Plaksha University; PhD – University of Oxford
- **Tapas Pandit** - Assistant Professor, Plaksha University; PhD – ISI Kolkata

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Mentor



Prof Rajesh Sharma
General Co-Chair



Prof Siddharth
General Co-Chair



Pawan Kumar
Event Lead



Palak Bisht
Team Member



Ishani Jain
Team Member



Shradha Rathour
Team Member



Khyati Sagar
Team Member



Abhijeet Singh
Team Member

List of Talks

Name	Conference Track	Abstract Title	Date and Time	Venue
Dr Santanu Chaudhury	*Plenary Keynote*	Causal and Explainable AI: Challenges of Solving Real-Life Problems	Oct 30, 2026 10:00 – 10:50 AM	Auditorium
B H V S P Subrahmanyam	*AI in Healthcare*	Generate, Verify and Select: Evolutionary Fitness Shaping for Safe Clinical Text Generation	Oct 30, 2026 11:05 AM – 12:45 PM	A3-007
Aarju Dixit	*AI in Healthcare*	FedBio-AD: Federated Learning-Enabled Digital Biomarker Framework for Early Alzheimer's Disease Detection	Oct 30, 2026 11:05 AM – 12:45 PM	A3-007
Antara Roy Choudhury	*AI in Healthcare*	Towards Scalable, Explainable Early Detection of Autism Spectrum Disorder Through Multimodal Behavior Modeling in Triadic Play	Oct 30, 2026 11:05 AM – 12:45 PM	A3-007
Dr Akshay S	*AI and Logic: Relations and Applications*	Logic and AI: Old Connections, New Frontiers	Oct 30, 2026 11:05 – 11:35 AM	A3-009
Ajay M Reje	*AI and Logic: Relations and Applications*	AI Futures Beyond Technological Determinism: Pratītyasamutpāda and the Relationality of Human-Machine Agency	Oct 30, 2026 11:05 AM – 12:45 PM	A3-009
Dr Rajesh Kumar	*AI and Logic: Relations and Applications*	Event-Centric Semantic Alignment of Vulnerabilities With Adversarial Attack Techniques	Oct 30, 2026 11:05 AM – 12:45 PM	A3-009
Abhishek Gupta	*AI and Logic: Relations and Applications*	Adapting to Evolving Graphs: A Scalable Framework for Dynamic Coarsening	Oct 30, 2026 11:05 AM – 12:45 PM	A3-009
Dr Parag Singla	*Plenary Keynote*	Neuro-Symbolic AI: Enhancing Capabilities of Generative Models and Challenges Ahead	Oct 30, 2026 2:10 – 3:00 PM	Auditorium
Zarka Bashir	*AI in the Economy*	FC2L: Federated Continual Graph Contrastive Learning for Evolving Cross-Bank Money Laundering Detection	Oct 30, 2026 3:10 – 4:50 PM	A3-007
Praveen Parthasarathy	*AI in the Economy*	AI Career and Financial Guidance Platform Designed to Close the Advisory Gap Facing Teens	Oct 30, 2026 3:10 – 4:50 PM	A3-007
Dr Mohan Kumar	*AI in Sensing*	AI in Sensing: From Raw Signals to Personal Insight in Wearables	Oct 30, 2026 3:10 – 3:40 PM	A3-009
Dr Debajyoti Biswas	*AI in Sensing*	Exploring Machine Learning and Large Language Models in Microelectronics	Oct 30, 2026 3:10 – 4:50 PM	A3-009
Devesh Bajaj	*AI in Sensing*	Detecting Asian Elephant Vocalizations Using CNN-LSTM Architecture From Acoustic Recordings	Oct 30, 2026 3:10 – 4:50 PM	A3-009
Dr Sanghamitra Bandyopadhyay	*Plenary Keynote*	Computational Methods for Life Sciences	Oct 31, 2026 9:10 – 10:00 AM	Auditorium

Name	Conference Track	Abstract Title	Date and Time	Venue
Dr Ponnurangam Kumaraguru	*Plenary Keynote*	Saral AI: Democratizing Scholarly Work by Transforming into Accessible, Multilingual Content	Oct 31, 2026 10:10 – 11:00 AM	Auditorium
Dr Nipun Batra	*AI4Cities: Resilience & Liveability*	AI for Cleaner Air: From Satellites to City Decisions	Oct 31, 2026 11:20 – 11:50 AM	A3-007
Anand Kumar Rai	*AI4Cities: Resilience & Liveability*	RailVaani: An Optimized Bilingual ASR Pipeline for Entity-Rich Railway Announcements	Oct 31, 2026 11:20 AM – 1:00 PM	A3-007
Dr Saurabh Sharma	*AI4Cities: Resilience & Liveability*	STARK: Enhancing Traffic Prediction Through Spatiotemporal Adaptive Refinement With Knowledge Distillation	Oct 31, 2026 11:20 AM – 1:00 PM	A3-007
Amal A	*AI4Cities: Resilience & Liveability*	Decoding Customer Experience From User-Generated Content: A Multilingual Aspect-Based Sentiment Analysis Approach	Oct 31, 2026 11:20 AM – 1:00 PM	A3-007
Anirban Majumdar	*Recent Advances in AI*	About Time: Model-Free Reinforcement Learning With Timed Reward Machines	Oct 31, 2026 11:20 AM – 1:00 PM	A3-009
Dr Manish Gupta	*Plenary Keynote*	The Transformative Power of AI and Open Challenges	Oct 31, 2026 3:00 – 3:50 PM	Auditorium
Panelists: Dr Balaraman Ravindran Dr Shachindra Nath Mr Anoop G Prabhu Prof M Balakrishnan **Moderator:** Prof Siddharth	*Panel Discussion*	Beyond Chatbots: Bridging the Gap Between AI Use and Real-World Impact in India	Oct 31, 2026 5:00 – 6:15 PM	Auditorium
Dr Balaraman Ravindran	*Plenary Keynote*	Measuring What Matters: Evaluation as the Foundation of AI Governance	Nov 1, 2026 9:10 – 10:00 AM	Auditorium
Dr Vineeth N Balasubramanian	*Reasoning in Vision Language Models*	Learning Beyond Prediction: Rethinking Reasoning in Multimodal Models	Nov 1, 2026 10:10 – 10:40 AM	Auditorium
Ayush Shrivastava	*Reasoning in Vision Language Models*	ThermEval: A Structured Benchmark for Evaluation of Vision-Language Models on Thermal Imagery	Nov 1, 2026 10:10 – 11:40 AM	Auditorium
Kartik Bose	*Reasoning in Vision Language Models*	How Much Did the Image Matter? An Audit of Evidence Use in Medical Vision-Language Models	Nov 1, 2026 10:10 – 11:40 AM	Auditorium
S Aarthi	*Responsible and Ethical AI*	Understanding Speech, Missing Deepfake Artifacts: The Explainability Gap in Audio Language Models	Nov 1, 2026 12:00 – 1:00 PM	Auditorium
Prashasti Agarwal	*Responsible and Ethical AI*	AI for Education Equity in Changing Higher Education: An Equity-Aware Learning Analytics Framework for India	Nov 1, 2026 12:00 – 1:00 PM	Auditorium
Amit Kalita	*Responsible and Ethical AI*	Operationalizing Fairness: A Bounded Threshold Heuristic Under Hard Resource Limits	Nov 1, 2026 12:00 – 1:00 PM	Auditorium
Sanchet Sharma	*Responsible and Ethical AI*	AI Personhood and the Colonial Architecture of Accountability: From Legal Fictions to Supervisory Strict Liability	Nov 1, 2026 12:00 – 1:00 PM	Auditorium

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